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CS 470 Final Reflection
https://youtu.be/EIdyuslcwKQ

The last eight weeks have been very educational. Many companies are moving toward cloud-based infrastructure, so knowing how to use the tools will be essential in my upcoming job hunt.

During this class I have learned the basics of databases with MongoDB and DynamoDB. I have learned Docker and how to create a Docker Compose script. I also worked a lot with AWS, learning how to create a static website with S3 buckets, create Lambdas to control data flow, DynamoDB to store data, and IAM roles and policies to secure the site.

My strengths as a software developer lie in creating well-formatted code and understanding instructions. With my new skills, I am prepared to take a job as a cloud developer, building enterprise-level applications or software services that work in the cloud.

Tech is always evolving and changing, so software developers always need to be ready to adapt to an ever-growing field. We should approach the situation with the understanding that it may be different in six months, and we should be flexible enough to meet the challenge.

Microservices are a common way to use cloud-based hosting. Instead of having one large app that does everything, services are broken up into smaller instances and handled separately. This makes it easier to scale as you can add a new service without having to

rewrite the whole app. It makes error handling more efficient, as well, because if one service goes down, it doesn't affect the whole app.

Predicting the cost for serverless computing can be difficult as many cloud hosting services use a pay-as-you-go model. This means a slow month may not cost much, but a heavy month might break the budget. However, it is still better than containers, as you pay for the provisioned capacity, regardless of how much traffic goes through it.

There are many pros and cons to expanding a project. Some pros include offering more services to your users, faster load times, and higher throughput. Cons include higher cost, more complex management, and the need to hire more personnel to manage it.

With serverless architecture the decision to expand can be streamlined. Scaling up or down to meet demand is done automatically due to the pay-as-you-go model. This can lead to cost savings as you aren't paying for what you aren't using.